

NovaPharma Iberia — Step 4.B Review: DAX Measures

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Why measures, if SQL already has the numbers?

The view `v_sales_enriched` already brings net sales and gross margin per invoice line. But a report never shows one line: it shows totals for whatever the user has selected (a region, a brand, a month). A column is a fixed value per row; a **measure** is an instruction that Power BI recalculates for every selection. The visual decides the grouping (by region, by brand...), and the measure only says how to aggregate. That is also why ratios must be measures: a margin % has to divide the totals of the selection, never average the percentages of the rows.

How we built them

All measures live in one empty table, `_measures`, split into two folders:

Folder	Measures	Idea
1 Base	Net Sales, Units, Gross Margin, Market Value, Plan Net Sales	Simple sums of the fact tables
2 KPIs	GM %, Market Share %, Net Sales YTD, Var vs Budget %	Built on top of the base measures

The base measures are written once and reused: GM % is $\text{Gross Margin} \div \text{Net Sales}$, and Market Share % is $\text{Net Sales} \div \text{Market Value}$. Net Sales YTD adds up from January to the latest month in the selection. Var vs Budget % compares actuals with budget only for months that already have sales, so an unfinished year doesn't look like a miss.

Validation

Every measure was checked in a card against the expected value:

Measure	Value	Check
Net Sales	443M	Same as SQL (442,941,738.80)
GM %	75.0 %	$\text{Gross Margin } 332\text{M} \div \text{Net Sales } 443\text{M}$
Market Share %	22.0 %	$\text{Net Sales } 443\text{M} \div \text{Market Value } 2,010\text{M}$
Net Sales YTD	138M	Jan–Sep 2026, about 15M per month
Var vs Budget %	–4.1 %	Closed months only

Preparing the model for the visuals

Before building any chart, we hid everything that shouldn't be dragged into a visual: the fact tables (the measures replace them), the foreign keys and technical columns. Hiding doesn't delete: relationships and measures keep using them. We also sorted month names chronologically and switched off Power BI's automatic date tables, since the model has its own calendar. The field list now shows only measures and the attributes you filter by, which makes building the visuals faster and harder to get wrong.

Result: 9 measures, validated, and a clean model ready for 4.C.